

Question 58 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Mention any two factors that should be considered while selecting a training method.

Introduction

Selecting a method means choosing OJT, lecture, case, role play, vestibule, simulation, e-learning, outdoor training, and so on — or a blend. Two headline factors for 8 marks: the learning objectives, and the nature of the task. Then list other factors (trainees, cost, location, culture) so the answer is complete.

Detailed points

- 1. First factor — learning objectives.** What must the person be able to do after training? Knowledge, skill and attitude need different methods. You cannot lecture people into a motor skill. You cannot only give an e-module and expect counselling skill. You cannot only do a game if they must memorise a legal checklist. Objectives, written in observable language from TNA, are the first selector of method.
- 2. Example.** Objective ‘explain three causes of defects’ can use discussion and quiz. Objective ‘replace a filter in eight minutes without leaks’ needs demonstration, simulation and OJT. Same department, different methods.
- 3. Second factor — nature of the job or task.** Dangerous or costly tasks need simulation or vestibule before live OJT (safety, aircraft, surgery, high-voltage). Simple routine skills already done well by seniors may use OJT. Customer-facing tasks need practice with feedback (role play). If the workplace currently teaches the wrong method, off-the-job is needed first so that bad habits are not copied.
- 4. Trainee characteristics.** Education, language, digital literacy, experience, motivation, number of people. Illiterate workers need demonstration, not dense e-text. Thousands of scattered staff favour e-learning for knowledge parts.
- 5. Cost, time and production loss.** Can the organisation spare people for five days off-site? Is the budget enough for a simulator? Method choice is also resource choice. Cheap methods that fail are not actually cheap.
- 6. Geography, facilities and trainer availability.** No lab means you cannot choose vestibule. No internal expert may mean a vendor or e-module. Distant plants change the choice toward e-learning plus local OJT coaches.
- 7. Transfer requirements and urgency.** If the skill must appear tomorrow on the job, OJT with a coach and a job aid may beat a delayed residential course. If the skill is rare, off-the-job practice may be safer.
- 8. Organisational culture and climate.** Will role play or open discussion be accepted, or seen as loss of face? Culture-blind method choice fails even if theoretically correct. Climate also decides whether any method will transfer.

Conclusion. Two main factors in selecting a training method are (1) the learning objectives (knowledge/skill/attitude) and (2) the nature of the task (danger, complexity, whether the workplace already models the right way). Also consider trainees, cost, location, urgency and culture. Method selection must be systematic, from TNA, not from habit.